

DEEP BLUE SEA (Freshwater Flora and Fauna)

DESCRIPTION: Teams will be assessed on their knowledge of oceanography, the freshwater flora and fauna of Florida, and aquatic animal life cycles.

COMPETITORS BRING/NEED:

- Writing utensil;
- 3-ring binder of any size with any research/reference material. The binder may contain any item, such as a book, computer generated printout, or student created paperwork. No electronic materials are allowed, such as a computer, calculator or smartphone. All materials must be securely bound inside the binder, so that when it is opened vertically (upside down) and given a light shake test no materials will fall out.

NUMBER OF PARTICIPANTS: Maximum of 2

IMPOUND: NO

THE COMPETITION:

1. The competition may include timed stations and/or timed slides/PowerPoint presentation(s).
2. In **Part I** the contestants will view pictures and answer questions relating to identifying **Intracoastal Waterway flora or fauna**. They may also be asked questions about the **Intracoastal Waterway organism's habitat, diet, or life cycle**.
3. The list of flora and fauna will come from the following list:

FLORA:

Sawgrass	Widgeon grass	Sweetgum
Water lily	Bald cypress	Buttonush
Cattail	Pond cypress	Yaupon
Maidencane	Water tupeloSwamp blackgum	Hydrilla
Pickernelweed	Sweetbay magnolia	Swamp rose
Bladderworts	Pond apple	Cinnamon fern
Spikerush		Royal fern

FAUNA:

American Alligator	Catfish	Americana flamingo
Banded Southern Water Snake	Florida Gar	Crested caracara
Water Moccasin	Tarpon	Osprey
Florida Softshell Turtle	Smalltooth Sawfish	Sandhill crane
Florida SnappingTurtle	Everglades Pygmy Sunfish	Wood stork
Diamondback Terrapin	Largemouth Bass	Anhinga
White tailed deer	Gulf Toadfish	Double-crested cormorant
Florida panther	Snook	Turkey vulture
Bobcat	Peacock Bass	Limpkin
North American river otter	Seminole Killifish	Peregrine falcon
Marsh rabbit	Brim	Great blue heron
	West Indian Manatee	Woodstork
	Mayfly	Redshouldered hawk
	Caddisfly	Snail kite
	Dragonfly	Cape Sable seaside sparrow
	Peregrine falcon	

4. In **Part II** the contestants will respond to a series of questions related to the following topics:
 - a. Physical features of oceans (trenches, seamounts, etc.)
 - b. Phenomena (tidal waves, currents, surface current, longshore currents, etc.)
 - c. Geography (location and identification of oceans, seas, major bays, etc.)
 - d. Conservation efforts to protect ocean animals and sea floor

RELATED FLORIDA STANDARDS:

3. SC.3.L.14.1 Describe structures in plants and their roles in food production, support, water, and nutrient transport, and reproduction.
4. SC.3.L.14.2 Investigate and describe how plants respond to stimuli (heat, light, gravity), such as the way plant stems grow toward light and their roots grow downward in response to gravity.
5. SC.3.L.15.1 Classify animals into major groups (mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, fish, vertebrates and invertebrates, those having live births and those which lay eggs) according to their physical characteristics and behaviors.
6. SC.4.L.16.4 Compare and contrast the major stages in the life cycles of Florida plants and animals such as those that undergo incomplete and complete metamorphosis, and flowering and nonflowering seed-bearing plants.
7. SC.4.L.17.4 Recognize ways plants and animals, including humans, can impact the environment.
8. SC.5.L.15.1 Describe how, when the environment changes, differences between individuals allow some plants and animals to survive and reproduce while others die or move to new locations.
9. SC.5.L.17.1 Compare and contrast adaptations displayed by animals and plants that enable them to survive in different environments such as life cycles, variation, animal behaviors, and physical characteristics.

SCORING:

- High score wins.
- Each question or station will be assigned a predetermined set of points by the event supervisor and communicated to the teams.
- Ties will be broken with pre-determined tie-breaker questions which are communicated to teams.

RESOURCES: